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Strongest Capability

Evidence-based root cause tracing. Across Days 1, 2, 3, and 6 I consistently found the origin failure before acting — port conflict, PostgreSQL write latency, disabled .env flag, webhook retry loop. In every case I rejected the loudest symptom and followed the evidence chain to the actual source.

Weakest Capability

AI trust judgment. I came into this challenge assuming AI suggestions would be correct by default. Day 5 exposed this directly: the Redis decrement plan looked authoritative and I had to reconstruct the failure sequence manually to find the flaw. The correct habit — treat every AI recommendation as a hypothesis requiring a failure-sequence test — was not my default. It became one through this challenge.

Repeated Behavioral Pattern

Across this week, I noticed that I tend to:

- Initially accept the framing given to me — by a founder, by AI, by the most visible symptom — and then correct course when the evidence doesn't match.
- Produce thorough, well-evidenced analysis once I start investigating correctly. The investigation quality was high. The trigger to start correctly needed practice.
- Self-correct well within a task, but the correction sometimes came one step later than it should have — after briefly going in the suggested direction.

AI-Era Strength

When using or judging AI, I am strongest at: modifying AI output rather than accepting or rejecting it wholesale. On Day 4 I rejected the full override module as wrong scope for the pilot. On Day 5 I blocked 3 recommendations, modified 1, and trusted 2 — each with a specific stated reason. On Day 6 I modified the AI rollback recommendation because I had operational context the AI didn't have (in-flight queued events that would land after a rollback).

Growth Gap

The engineering habit I need to build next: stress-testing AI recommendations immediately by asking 'what is the failure sequence if this is wrong?' before moving to any next step. I get there — but not always as my first move.

Honest Self-Observation

Under pressure, I tend to: act decisively once I have a clear evidence chain. But I sometimes needed one wrong move or one piece of contradicting evidence to trigger the proper investigation mode.

I need to improve: questioning the premise before I start — not just during. The pattern across Days 1, 2, and 5 is that I corrected the founder/AI framing, but after briefly accepting it first.

30-Day Commitment

For the next 30 days, I will practice: before every debugging session or feature decision, writing one sentence declaring the actual workflow or hypothesis I am testing — and running it before I read anyone else's framing of the problem. This forces premise questioning before investigation, not during.